

Module 7: Hashtags & Social Media SEO

Master the tools that help your content get discovered — hashtags, keywords, Instagram SEO, and search-friendly captions. By the end of this module, you'll know how to build a smarter discoverability strategy that works for real businesses.

THRM DIGITAL · BEGINNER COURSE



Learning Objectives

This module covers the core skills every social media marketer needs to make content findable — not just good-looking.

01

Understand Hashtags

What they are, how they work, and how to use them strategically.

02

Keywords on Social Media

How keywords differ from hashtags and where to place them effectively.

03

Instagram SEO

Optimize your profile and captions so users — and the platform — can find you.

04

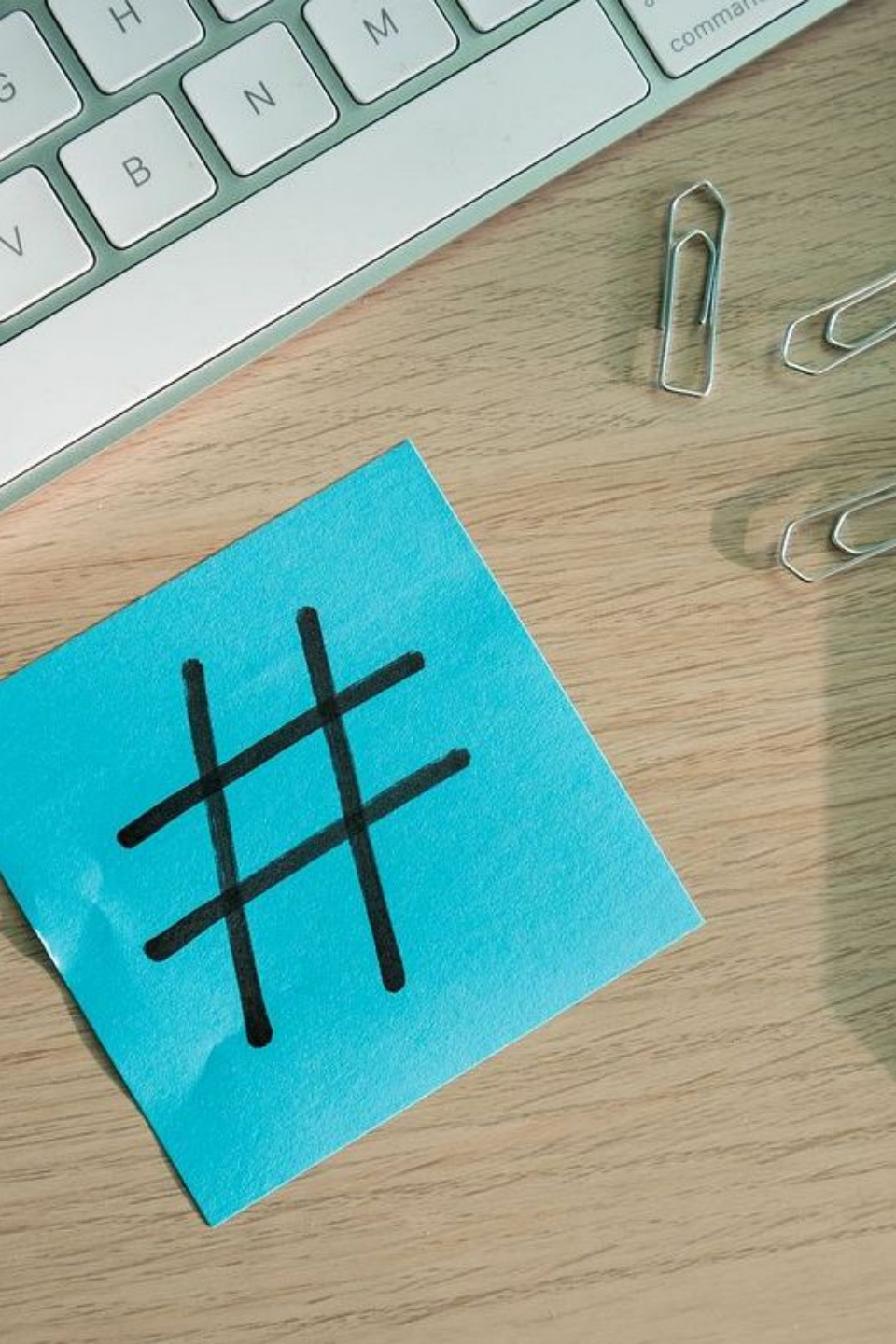
Search Intent & Local SEO

Match your content to what your audience is actually looking for.

05

Avoid Common Mistakes

Keyword stuffing, irrelevant hashtags, and other pitfalls to sidestep.



What Are Hashtags — And What They're Not

What a Hashtag Is

A hashtag is a word or phrase preceded by the # symbol. It categorizes content around a topic, service, industry, or location — helping platforms and users understand what a post is about.

- #BridalMakeup — the service
- #MumbaiCafe — the location
- #FitnessTips — the topic
- #DigitalMarketing — the industry

The #1 Beginner Misconception

Many beginners believe: *"If I add 30 hashtags, my Reel will go viral."*

That's not how social media marketing works. Hashtags **support discoverability** — but content quality, relevance, audience interest, and platform signals matter far more.



Hashtags are a context signal, not a virality guarantee.

Hashtag Strategy: Relevance Over Popularity

A good hashtag strategy means selecting hashtags **intentionally** — not just grabbing the ones with the biggest numbers. Consider relevance, content topic, audience, location, industry, and search intent.

Broad Only

#Beauty
#Makeup
#Fashion

High competition. Your content drowns in millions of posts.

Relevant Mix

#MumbaiMakeupArtist
#BridalMakeupMumbai
#IndianBridalMakeup

Specific, targeted, and clearly connected to your actual content.

A smaller, highly relevant audience is more valuable than a massive but uninterested one. Specific hashtags like **#MumbaiBridalMakeup** tell the platform — and the viewer — exactly what the content is about. Branded hashtags like **#CoffeeWithXYZ** can also organize campaigns, user-generated content, and community participation.

Keywords vs. Hashtags: Know the Difference

Hashtag

#MumbaiMakeupArtist — a clickable, categorized tag placed in a caption or comment to signal a topic to the platform.

Keyword

Mumbai makeup artist — a natural phrase describing what someone searches for, woven into your content and profile.

Keywords appear in captions, bios, profile names, video on-screen text, and alt text. Hashtags are just *one* tool in a broader discoverability strategy.

Where Keywords Live

- **Profile Name & Username**
- **Bio**
- **Captions**
- **Video Context & On-Screen Text**
- **Alt Text (where applicable)**

Instagram SEO: Make Your Profile Work for You

Instagram SEO means optimizing your profile and content so the platform understands what your account is about — and shows it to the right people. Here's what that looks like in practice.

Profile A ❌

Username: @riya12345

Name: Riya

Bio: Makeup | Fashion | Lifestyle

Creative — but gives no useful context about services or location.

Profile B ✅

Username: @riyabridalmakeup

Name: Riya | Bridal Makeup Artist Mumbai

Bio: Bridal & Occasion Makeup Artist · Mumbai | Thane | Navi
Mumbai · Bookings open

Immediately communicates what she does, where she works, and that she's available.

📌 The goal isn't to trick Instagram — it's to make your content clear, relevant, and findable.



Writing Search-Friendly Captions

A search-friendly caption naturally includes words that describe the content's topic — without sounding robotic or forced.

✗ Too Vague

"Time to get stronger."

Sounds motivating, but gives no context. No location, no service, no searchable signal.

✓ Search-Friendly

"Looking for a beginner-friendly gym in Thane? Here are 3 things to check before choosing a fitness studio."

Keywords integrated naturally: **beginner-friendly gym • Thane • fitness studio**

⚠ Keyword Stuffing

"Mumbai makeup artist. Best Mumbai makeup artist. Bridal makeup artist Mumbai. Mumbai bridal makeup artist."

Hard to read. Looks spammy. Reduces user trust and brand credibility.

Search Intent: Match Content to What People Actually Want

Understanding **why** someone searches matters as much as understanding **what** they search. Create content that matches the intent behind the query.



Informational Intent

The person wants to learn.

"How does Instagram SEO work?"

→ Create educational content: guides, tips, explainers.



Commercial Intent

The person is comparing options.

"Best digital marketing agency in Mumbai."

→ Create case studies, comparisons, testimonials.



Transactional Intent

The person is ready to act.

"Book bridal makeup artist Mumbai."

→ Share packages, availability, and a clear CTA.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

1 Using Random Popular Hashtags

Popular ≠ relevant. #Bollywood on a digital marketing post adds no useful context.

2 Recycling the Same Hashtags on Every Post

Hashtags should reflect each post's specific topic, not your go-to default list.

3 Ignoring Location (for Local Businesses)

"Best vibes ever" tells nobody where you are. "Cosy café in Kalyan" does.

4 Keyword Stuffing

Repeating keywords unnaturally damages readability, trust, and the user experience.

5 Optimizing Only the Caption

SEO spans your profile name, bio, content text, and overall account context — not just captions.

6 Writing Only for Algorithms

People are the audience. If humans don't find it useful, no amount of optimization will help.

Putting It All Together: A Full Strategy Example

Here's how every element of this module works together for a single business account.

The Business

Bridal Makeup Artist · Mumbai

Instagram Name

Riya | Bridal Makeup Artist Mumbai

Bio

Bridal & Occasion Makeup Artist · Mumbai | Thane | Navi Mumbai ·
Bookings open for 2026 · DM to enquire

Target Keywords

- Bridal makeup artist Mumbai
- Wedding makeup Mumbai
- Mumbai makeup artist

Search-Friendly Caption

"Soft-glam bridal makeup for a Mumbai bride — glowing skin, defined eyes, and a timeless finish. Looking for a bridal makeup artist in Mumbai for your wedding? DM us to check availability."

Relevant Hashtags

#BridalMakeupMumbai · #MumbaiMakeupArtist · #MumbaiBride · #IndianBridalMakeup · #BridalMakeupArtist

 Keywords and hashtags support the caption — they don't take it over.

THRM Beginner Tip: Don't write for the algorithm first. Write for the person searching. If your content clearly answers their need, you're already moving in the right direction.